SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

20 October 2020 · Shift 2

50 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 50 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 25 questions

Q.1

Identify the segment in the given sentence which contains the grammatical error. Soni take her daughter to the park in the evening in a stroller.

(A) to the park
(B) in a stroller
(C) Soni take her daughter
(D) in the evening

Q.2

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Unpretensious
(B) Excellence
(C) Recurrent
(D) Dilemma

Q.3

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A type of magic in which spirits, especially evil ones, are used to make things happen

(A) Chemistry
(B) Mimicry
(C) Sorcery
(D) Alchemy

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank in the given sentence. We must not take the future for granted; rather, we should enjoy the _____ joys of our humdrum lives.

(A) average
(B) everyday
(C) future
(D) habitual

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the reasons we fail to talk convincingly about climate change is that we present it as something “out there”. We (1)_____ to make it clear (2)_____ it’s linked to (3)_____ daily decisions, such as walking (4)_____ driving, and not talk about it in (5)_____ of abstractions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) need
(B) use
(C) keep
(D) know

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the reasons we fail to talk convincingly about climate change is that we present it as something “out there”. We (1)_____ to make it clear (2)_____ it’s linked to (3)_____ daily decisions, such as walking (4)_____ driving, and not talk about it in (5)_____ of abstractions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) so
(B) if
(C) then
(D) that

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the reasons we fail to talk convincingly about climate change is that we present it as something “out there”. We (1)_____ to make it clear (2)_____ it’s linked to (3)_____ daily decisions, such as walking (4)_____ driving, and not talk about it in (5)_____ of abstractions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) our
(B) their
(C) those
(D) much

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the reasons we fail to talk convincingly about climate change is that we present it as something “out there”. We (1)_____ to make it clear (2)_____ it’s linked to (3)_____ daily decisions, such as walking (4)_____ driving, and not talk about it in (5)_____ of abstractions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) never
(B) also
(C) before
(D) or

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the reasons we fail to talk convincingly about climate change is that we present it as something “out there”. We (1)_____ to make it clear (2)_____ it’s linked to (3)_____ daily decisions, such as walking (4)_____ driving, and not talk about it in (5)_____ of abstractions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) words
(B) terms
(C) things
(D) voices

Q.10

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A deep fissure in the earth's surface

(A) Volcano
(B) Chasm
(C) Earthquake
(D) Tremor

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. “Have you got confirmation” of the receipt of the donation?

(A) Has you got confirmations
(B) No improvement
(C) Did you got confirmation
(D) Have you get confirmation

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank in the given sentence. A literature festival on the beach: With waves crashing on the beach, the Kerala Literature Festival got _____ in Kozhikode with a range of panel discussions in English and Malayalam.

(A) away
(B) underway
(C) wayward
(D) apart

Q.13

Select the option that is the passive form of the given sentence. This book explores the secret of leading a long and meaningful life.

(A) The secret of leading a long and meaningful life is explored in this book.
(B) The secret of leading a long and meaningful life was being explored by this book.
(C) The secret of leading a long and meaningful life have been explored by this book.
(D) The secret of leading a long and meaningful life had been explored by this book.

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. MOTIF

(A) Design
(B) Reason
(C) Purpose
(D) Creation

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Have you heard the news that Hema is “looking for greener pastures?”

(A) has been transferred
(B) was feeling rejected
(C) exploring new opportunities
(D) has been fired

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. EXPUNGE

(A) Remove
(B) Insert
(C) Deplete
(D) Exhaust

Q.17

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. The father then wanted his son to pick him up at four in the afternoon so that they could go home together. B. A teenager had just passed his driving test and was eager to drive his father’s car. C. He asked his son to drop him at a place that was some 18 miles from home before he took the car for servicing. D. His father agreed.

(A) BDCA
(B) ADBC
(C) CBAD
(D) BCAD

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Ashutosh “kept a stiff upper lip” even when he was reprimanded in the presence of clients.

(A) remained expressionless
(B) started sniggering
(C) behaved insolently
(D) kept shouting

Q.19

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Recquirement
(B) Exquiste
(C) Acquaintance
(D) Squirrell

Q.20

Identify the segment in the given sentence which contains the grammatical error. The wedding reception will be hosted in Mumbai at a late date.

(A) in Mumbai
(B) will be hosted
(C) at a late date
(D) The wedding reception

Q.21

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. “The book’s page seem” to have been torn by someone.

(A) The book’s page seems
(B) The page of the book was seems
(C) The page of the book has seem
(D) No improvement

Q.22

Select the option that is the direct form of the given sentence. Explaining her work she said that she made films for posterity to remember.

(A) Explaining her work, she said, “She makes films for posterity to remember.”
(B) Explaining her work, she said, “I will make the films that will remember posterity.”
(C) Explaining her work, she said, “She made films for posterity to remember.”
(D) Explaining her work, she said, “I make films for posterity to remember.”

Q.23

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. APEX

(A) Force
(B) Asset
(C) Base
(D) Pinnacle

Q.24

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. ACCRUE

(A) Range
(B) Variety
(C) Collect
(D) Spread

Q.25

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. In reality, however, we exist in compartments, separated by walls of caste, religion, and geography. B. But we find that ignorance levels are growing as well because the rate at which we are accumulating information is not commensurate with the rate at which our awareness is growing. C. Technologically we live in a borderless world. D. Another paradox is that we take pride in describing ourselves as a knowledge-based society.

(A) ABDC
(B) CADB
(C) CBAD
(D) BADC

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

'Wings India’, Asia’s largest civil aviation event, will be held at Begumpet airport, Hyderabad in March 2020. What will be the theme of this event?

(A) Flying for All
(B) Born to Fly
(C) Flying Everyone
(D) Women to Fly

Q.2

Which scientist won the Nobel prize in Physics in 1918 for the discovery of ‘Energy Quanta’?

(A) Louis de Broglie
(B) Werner Heisenberg
(C) James Chadwick
(D) Max Karl Ernst Ludwig Planck

Q.3
Which of the following rivers is the fifth largest river and the largest west flowing river?

(A) Narmada river
(B) Arvari river
(C) Godavari river
(D) Subarnarekha river

Q.4
'A Shot At History: My Obsessive Journey to Olympic Gold' is the autobiography of which Indian shooter?

(A) Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore
(B) Jitu Rai
(C) Abhinav Bindra
(D) Gagan Narang

Q.5
The famous cultural site Rani-ki-Vav (the Queen's Stepwell) is situated on the banks of which river?

(A) Saraswati River
(B) Yamuna River
(C) Hooghly River
(D) Mahanadi

Q.6
Who is India's youngest IAS officer to be appointed to the Chief Minister's Office of Telangana? She/he is also known as 'The People's Officer'.

(A) Ansar Ahmad Shaikh
(B) Amrutesh Aurangabadkar
(C) Smita Sabharwal
(D) Swati Meena Naik

Q.7
The definition of ‘money bills’ is given in which article of the Constitution of India?

(A) Article 44
(B) Article 110
(C) Article 33
(D) Article 93

Q.8
Which wildlife sanctuary is a tri-state protected area in northern India? It is also famous for the Critically Endangered gharial, the red-crowned roofed turtle and the Endangered Ganges river dolphin?

(A) National Chambal Sanctuary
(B) Chinnar Wildlife Sanctuary
(C) Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary
(D) Bhadra Wildlife Sanctuary

Q.9
In November 2019, which Indian athlete was listed in ‘Time 100 Next’ that spotlights 100 rising stars who are shaping the future of business, entertainment, sports, politics, etc.?

(A) Anju Bobby George
(B) PV Sindhu
(C) Dutee Chand
(D) Hima Das

Q.10
Who created history by securing Gold in the women's Singles SL3 event at the ‘BWF Para-Badminton World Championships’ in 2019?

(A) Manasi Joshi
(B) Sujirat Pookkham
(C) Parul Dalsukhbhai Parmar
(D) Sarina Satomi

Q.11
Which of the following dance forms is also known as the 'Royal Dance of Ladakh'?

(A) Yak dance
(B) Jabro dance
(C) Shondol dance
(D) Koshan dance

Q.12
Which of the following movements was started in the year 1930 by Mahatma Gandhi?

(A) Non-Cooperation Movement
(B) Civil Disobedience Movement
(C) Khilafat Movement
(D) Quit India Movement

Q.13
Where did the Chief Minister of Odisha, Naveen Patnaik, inaugurate the National Tribal Craft Mela-2019?

(A) Cuttack
(B) Bhubaneswar
(C) Puri
(D) Konark

Q.14
As of January 2020, what was the upper limit of fund transfer using Unified Payments Interface (UPI)?

(A) ₹1 lakh
(B) ₹2 lakh
(C) ₹50,000
(D) ₹90,000

Q.15
Which of the following is the chemical formula for Nitre (saltpeter)?

(A) $KCl.MgCl_2$
(B) KNO_3
(C) KCl
(D) KAl_2O_3

Q.16
Which of the following mountains is situated near the Siachen region of Ladakh in India?

(A) Kirat Chuli Mountain
(B) Kabru Mountain
(C) Kangchenjunga Mountain
(D) K12 Mountain

Q.17
In the context of computers, WORM is an acronym of:

(A) Write Once, Read Many
(B) Wireless Operating, Read Module
(C) Word Optical, Recognition Malware
(D) Word On, RAM Memory

Q.18
Which country honoured Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi with its highest civilian honour 'Zayed Medal' in 2019?

(A) Portugal
(B) Bhutan
(C) UAE
(D) Israel

Q.19
As per a World Gold Council (WGC) report that was released in January 2020, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) was ranked _____ in terms of buying gold abroad among central banks of the world.

(A) Seventh
(B) Sixth
(C) Tenth
(D) Fifth

Q.20
Which of the following passes is located between Nilgiri Hills to the north and Anaimalai Hills to the south?

(A) Aghil Pass
(B) Karakoram Pass
(C) Rohtang Pass
(D) Palghat Pass

Q.21
Which of the following books was translated as 'The Razmnama' (Book of Wars) during the reign of Akbar?

(A) Ramayana
(B) Babur Nama
(C) Mahabharata
(D) Akbar Nama

Q.22

According to the Carbon Disclosure Project (CDP) annual report that was released in January 2020, what was India's rank in corporate commitments to science-based targets?

(A) Eight
(B) Tenth
(C) Fifth
(D) Sixth

Q.23

The 5th edition of 'Indian International Science Festival (IISF) 2019' was held in which city?

(A) Kolkata
(B) Delhi
(C) Chandigarh
(D) Hyderabad

Q.24

Which former cricketer and captain of the Indian team was formally elected as the President of BCCI in October 2019?

(A) Kapil Dev
(B) Sourav Ganguly
(C) Sunil Gavaskar
(D) Ravi Shastri

Q.25

In the context of the contribution of scientists for which they were awarded Nobel Prize, which of the following pairs is INCORRECT?

(A) Light scattering – CV Raman
(B) Diffraction of X-rays – Max Von Laue
(C) Zeeman Effect – Hendrik Lorentz
(D) Quantum mechanics – Galileo Galilei

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (C) Soni take her daughter

The singular subject 'Soni' takes a singular verb in the simple present: 'Soni takes her daughter to the park ...'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Unpretensious

'Unpretensious' is misspelt: the word is 'unpretentious', modest and not trying to impress.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Sorcery

Sorcery is magic that uses the power of spirits, especially evil ones. Alchemy was the medieval search for a way to turn base metals into gold, and mimicry is imitation.

Q.4 · Answer (B) everyday

'Everyday' (one word, an adjective) means ordinary and daily, which goes with 'humdrum lives'. 'Habitual' means done out of habit, and 'future' contradicts the sentence.

Q.5 · Answer (A) need

'Need to' says what must be done: 'We need to make it clear ...'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) that

'Make it clear that' introduces the clause saying what is to be made clear: 'that it's linked to our daily decisions'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) our

The writer includes the reader, as 'we' in the same sentence shows: climate change is linked to 'our' daily decisions.

Q.8 · Answer (D) or

'Or' joins the two alternatives of the daily choice: 'walking or driving'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) terms

'In terms of' means with regard to: not talk about it 'in terms of abstractions'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Chasm

A chasm is a deep crack or opening in the ground. A tremor is a slight shaking of the ground and an earthquake a violent one.

Q.11 · Answer (B) No improvement

'Have you got' is correct: 'has' needs a third-person subject, 'did' takes the base form ('did you get'), and 'have' takes the participle 'got', not 'get'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) underway

To 'get underway' is to begin: the festival began in Kozhikode. 'Wayward' means wilful and hard to control.

Q.13 · Answer (A) The secret of leading a long and meaningful life is explored in this book.

The simple present 'explores' becomes 'is explored' with the singular subject 'the secret': 'The secret of leading a long and meaningful life is explored in this book.'

Q.14 · Answer (A) Design

A motif is a decorative design or pattern, or an idea that recurs in a work: 'design'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) exploring new opportunities

To look for 'greener pastures' is to seek better opportunities elsewhere, often a new job.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Insert

To 'expunge' is to erase or remove completely; its opposite is 'insert'. 'Deplete' and 'exhaust' mean to use up.

Q.17 · Answer (A) BDCA
B introduces the teenager eager to drive his father's car, D says the father agreed, C has the son drop him 18 miles from home before taking the car for servicing, and A, with 'then', adds the pick-up at four in the afternoon: BDCA.

Q.18 · Answer (A) remained expressionless
To keep a 'stiff upper lip' is to hide one's feelings and stay calm in difficulty: Ashutosh showed no reaction to the scolding.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Acquaintance
'Acquaintance' is spelt correctly; the others should be 'requirement', 'exquisite' and 'squirrel'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) at a late date
'At a later date', meaning at some time in the future, is the fixed phrase: 'The wedding reception will be hosted in Mumbai at a later date.'

Q.21 · Answer (A) The book’s page seems
The singular subject 'page' takes the singular verb 'seems': 'The book's page seems to have been torn by someone.'

Q.22 · Answer (D) Explaining her work, she said, “I make films for posterity to remember.”
In direct speech the reported 'she' becomes 'I' and the past 'made' returns to the present 'make': 'I make films for posterity to remember.'

Q.23 · Answer (C) Base
The apex is the top or highest point; its opposite is the 'base'. 'Pinnacle' means the same as 'apex'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Collect
To 'accrue' is to collect or build up over time, as interest does on a deposit.

Q.25 · Answer (B) CADB
C says technology has made the world borderless; A ('however') says that in reality we live in compartments; D adds 'another paradox', that we call ourselves a knowledge-based society; and B ('but') says ignorance is growing too: CADB.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Flying for All
The theme of Wings India 2020, the civil aviation show organised by the Ministry of Civil Aviation, the Airports Authority of India and FICCI at Begumpet Airport, Hyderabad, for 12 to 15 March 2020, was 'Flying for All'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Max Karl Ernst Ludwig Planck
The 1918 Nobel Prize in Physics went to Max Planck for his discovery of energy quanta, the start of quantum theory. De Broglie won in 1929, Heisenberg in 1932 and Chadwick, for the neutron, in 1935.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Narmada river
The Narmada, which rises at Amarkantak, is the largest of the west-flowing rivers of peninsular India and runs through a rift valley to the Arabian Sea. The Godavari and the Subarnarekha flow east to the Bay of Bengal.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Abhinav Bindra
'A Shot at History', written with Rohit Brijnath, is the autobiography of Abhinav Bindra, who won India's first individual Olympic gold, in the 10 m air rifle at Beijing 2008.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Saraswati River
Rani-ki-Vav, an 11th-century stepwell at Patan in Gujarat, stands on the banks of the Saraswati; it became a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2014.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Smita Sabharwal
SSC's key gives Smita Sabharwal, a 2001-batch IAS officer who in 2014 became the first woman officer appointed to the Telangana Chief Minister's Office, and who is known as 'the people's officer' for drawing citizens into solving local problems.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Article 110
Article 110 defines a money bill. Article 33 lets Parliament restrict fundamental rights for the armed forces, Article 44 deals with a uniform civil code and Article 93 with the Speaker and Deputy Speaker of the Lok Sabha.

Q.8 · Answer (A) National Chambal Sanctuary
The National Chambal Sanctuary runs along the Chambal through Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh and protects the gharial, the red-crowned roofed turtle and the Ganges river dolphin. The other three sanctuaries are in Kerala and Karnataka.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Dutee Chand
The sprinter Dutee Chand was among the advocates on TIME's first '100 Next' list, published in November 2019.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Manasi Joshi
Manasi Joshi won the women's singles SL3 gold at the 2019 BWF Para-Badminton World Championships in Basel, Switzerland, beating Parul Parmar in the final.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Shondol dance
Shondol, once performed for the kings of Ladakh on special occasions, is known as its royal dance. Jabro is a dance of the nomads of Changthang.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Civil Disobedience Movement
Gandhi began the Civil Disobedience Movement in 1930 with the Dandi March, breaking the salt law. The Khilafat Movement began in 1919, the Non-Cooperation Movement in 1920 and the Quit India Movement in 1942.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Bhubaneswar
The eighth National Tribal Craft Mela was held at the State Tribal Museum complex in Bhubaneswar, Odisha's capital, from 23 to 29 November 2019; Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik opened it.

Q.14 · Answer (A) ₹1 lakh
In January 2020 NPCI's general limit for a UPI transfer was ₹1 lakh per transaction.

Q.15 · Answer (B) KNO_3
Nitre, or saltpetre, is potassium nitrate, KNO_3, used in gunpowder and fertilisers. KCl is potassium chloride.

Q.16 · Answer (D) K12 Mountain
K12, a peak of the Saltoro range, rises near the Siachen Glacier. Kangchenjunga, Kabru and Kirat Chuli stand on the Sikkim-Nepal border.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Write Once, Read Many
WORM, Write Once, Read Many, is storage that can be written only once and then read any number of times, such as a CD-R.

Q.18 · Answer (C) UAE
The UAE announced its highest civilian honour, the Zayed Medal, for Narendra Modi in April 2019 and presented it to him in Abu Dhabi in August 2019.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Sixth
The World Gold Council's report of January 2020 ranked the RBI sixth among the world's central banks buying gold, with 25.2 tonnes in the first ten months of 2019; only the central banks of Russia, Turkey, Poland, China and Kazakhstan bought more.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Palghat Pass
The Palghat (Palakkad) Gap, between the Nilgiris to the north and the Anaimalai Hills to the south, links Kerala and Tamil Nadu. The other three passes are in the Himalaya and the Karakoram.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Mahabharata
The Razmnama is the Persian translation of the Mahabharata made at Akbar's court. The Baburnama is Babur's memoir and the Akbarnama Abul Fazl's history of Akbar's reign.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Fifth
The Carbon Disclosure Project's India report of January 2020 ranked India fifth among the countries surveyed for companies committed to science-based targets, emission cuts in line with what climate science says is needed.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Kolkata
The fifth India International Science Festival was held in Kolkata in November 2019.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Sourav Ganguly
Sourav Ganguly, a former India captain, was elected unopposed as president of the BCCI and took charge on 23 October 2019.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Quantum mechanics – Galileo Galilei
Galileo (1564-1642) lived centuries before the first Nobel Prizes of 1901, and quantum mechanics came only in the 20th century. Raman (1930), von Laue (1914) and Lorentz (1902, shared with Zeeman) won for the other three.

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